

SETTING UP HOME



A nest is a cradle in which eggs and baby birds are kept safe from enemies such as snakes and rats. Nests can be holes in trees, mounds of earth, or piles of branches. Greenfinches tuck their cup-shaped nests into bushes where they cannot be seen, whereas eagles' lofty nests are easy to see but hard to reach. Each species tries to give its chicks the best chance of survival.



Building a nursery

In many species of birds, both parents build the nest. These long-legged great blue herons are trampling on twigs to make a huge, cup-shaped nest.



Cattle hair



Seeds



String



Tinfoil

Nesting material

Birds, just like people, build their homes out of all sorts of things. Most nests are made with twigs and leaves, but a few use much stranger ingredients, such as string.

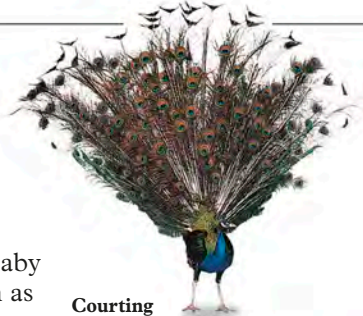
Many songbirds glue their nest together with sticky cobwebs!

Birds may make thousands of trips to collect all their nesting material.



Spot the eggs

Ringed plovers don't build a nest. They lay their pebblelike eggs on the beach.



Courting

Before starting a family, male birds have to attract a mate. Peacocks do this by showing off!